Full-stack platform engineering

Vidhyut Gopinath

Software Engineer IV / Cisco Secure Firewall

Tracy, CA • (408) 204-3970 • vidhyutap@gmail.com • LinkedIn • vidhyutg.github.io

Builds secure platforms from hardware interfaces and firmware through Linux, networking, and applications. Combines deep implementation ownership with the architecture, validation discipline, and coaching that make complex engineering work repeatable.

Firmware | Platform OS | Switching | PHY | Applications | Security

Experience

Cisco Systems, Inc.

Security Business Group / San Jose, CA

Software Engineer IV	Nov 2026 - Present
Software Engineer III	Nov 2024 - Oct 2026
Software Engineer II	Jan 2023 - Nov 2024
Technical Undergraduate Intern	Jun - Aug 2022

Application lifecycle

Redesigned firewall OS application lifecycle processes, cutting multi-application deployment from **~4 hours to 35 minutes** (approximately **85% less time**).

Platform delivery

Delivered Secure Firewall bring-up as the **sole engineer executing the scope of 4+ teams**, spanning firmware, FXOS, switching and PHY hardware, applications, datapath, and QDMA.

Now driving accelerated bring-up of **two new firewall platforms**, spanning hardware, OS, applications, and security.

Security and federal compliance

Contributed to **Project Glasswing** from Cisco's next-generation firewall OS team, **fixing critical vulnerabilities**.

Owned **Build Environment Security (BES) for federal compliance**, completing 33 improvements across segmented firmware builds, authenticated source access, artifact and dependency tracking, and publication validation.

Engineering leadership and follow-through

Help shape **AI-native engineering** across the organization; lead US Firewall AI-for-SDLC participation and coach engineers on practical adoption and critical review.

Built AI-assisted platform and firmware workflows backed by **280 local tests**; authored **29 engineering and onboarding pages**. Carry work through review, builds, artifact checks, and device validation.

Earlier experience

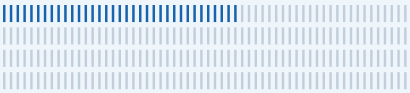
AT&T / Business Sales Expert Sep 2017 - Apr 2022
Exceeded revenue targets; recognized by market leadership.

Microsoft / Product Advisor Sep 2017 - Sep 2018
Led weekly coding and robotics workshops; December 2017 MVP.

Selected impact

~85%

less time to deploy multiple firewall applications



One mark per minute: 35 now, about 240 before

50.6%

lower peak virtual memory

31.0%

lower high-water resident memory

FXOS Service Manager. Bars show remaining usage.

Technical depth

Systems
C, C++, Python, shell, Linux, ARM64/x86

Platform
Firmware, FXOS, switching, PHY, applications, datapath, QDMA

Build and security
Make, Bazel, Yocto/BitBake, Jenkins, Git, signing, post-quantum cryptography

Diagnostics
GDB, Valgrind, address/leak sanitizers, kernel crash dumps

Education

San Jose State University
Bachelor's Degree, Software Engineering
May 2023